



COALITION UPDATE

A round-up of the tools and resources we've been building for Westchester | Summer 2026

To our coalition members,

It's been a busy and productive season for the Clean Energy Action Coalition. Behind the scenes, our working groups have developed a growing library of resources to do three things: educate local decision-makers, counter the misinformation that can stall worthwhile clean energy projects, and give our members practical tools they can put to use right away.

This update highlights our latest tools, guides, and resources to help you navigate today's clean energy issues. Click any link below to access the information, and visit our Resource Center at the end of this update to explore the complete collection.

Battery Storage: A Toolkit for Local Leaders

Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) have been our most active area of focus, and we've devoted significant effort to developing resources that help municipalities make informed decisions. Our goal has remained consistent: to help communities realize the benefits of battery storage while prioritizing safety, and to provide a model local law as a practical alternative to moratoriums or outright bans.



[A Guide for Westchester's Local Leaders](#)

The full CEAC briefing deck: what BESS is, why it matters, safety, and model policy.



[Westchester BESS Fact Sheet \(Two-Page Handout\)](#)

The essentials on a shareable two-page fact sheet for residents and officials.



[Energy Storage Fire & Safety Fact Sheet](#)

How modern BESS is engineered and regulated for fire safety, with risk in perspective.



[BESS Economic & Community Considerations](#)

The local economic and community benefits of storage for Westchester municipalities.



[Legal Moratorium Criteria Summary](#)

A concise summary of the legal criteria that apply to local BESS moratoriums.



[Filed Decision \(Yorktown ESS v. ZBA\)](#)

Full text of the landmark ruling that BESS qualifies as a public utility use.

Explore the full collection. The complete set of resources, guides, recaps, fact sheets, and more, is gathered on our resources page, where you can read each one as a page-turning book: [Resource Center](#).

Tracking the Landscape: Our Live BESS Policy Dashboard

Alongside these documents, we maintain a live [BESS Policy Dashboard & Moratorium Tracker](#): an interactive map of where every Westchester town stands on battery-storage regulation, updated as towns act.

Out in the Field: Recent Coalition Activity

Resources only matter if they're in use, so our working groups have stayed active on the ground:

- **Firefighter safety training with the County.** We're planning a Fall session focused on battery-storage safety and emergency response for local first responders, in coordination with Westchester County, reinforcing our safety-first approach with the people on the front lines.
- **Working with the Town of Cortlandt.** We recently met with Cortlandt and are helping the town develop its own materials, while exploring a potential municipal site for battery storage. It's a model for the kind of collaborative, benefits-plus-safety partnership we want with every community.
- **Ongoing working groups.** Our Schools, Workforce, and Solar-BESS coordinating groups continue to meet, sharing expertise across the coalition's 130+ members.

Conference Insights: Four Deep-Dive Recaps

From our Westchester Clean Energy Action Conference, we've turned four of the most substantive roundtables into shareable Key Insights recaps: practical, sourced write-ups that let members who couldn't attend still benefit from the room.



[Climate Smart Communities](#)

Zoning as a climate tool, and financing green affordable housing.



[Stormwater Resiliency & Financing](#)

Paying for flood resilience, from bonding to public-private deals.



[Clean Energy Workforce](#)

Why building the clean-energy workforce is harder than it looks.



[Passive House for Mixed-Use & Multifamily](#)

High-performance building at scale, where economics increasingly favor it.

As always: please share these resources widely, put them to work in your own communities, and let us know how we can help. Always and everywhere.

With appreciation,

The BCW Clean Energy Action Coalition

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